JAMES JOYCE + Eveline + Gabriel's epiphany

LIFE & WORKS:

Born in Dublin in 1882

↳ educated at Jesuit schools → then University College

→ interest for European culture ↳ focused on Modern languages

THE ONLY WAY TO INCREASE IRELAND'S AWARENESS WAS BY OFFERING A REALISTIC PORTRAIT OF ITS LIFE FROM A EUROPEAN

→ first short story: "The Sisters" → opening story of Dubliners

1904 → fell in love with Nora Barnacle

↳ Their first date = "Bloomsday" of Ulysses

TRIESTE 1905-1915

The years in Trieste were difficult

↳ he was in trouble with publishers and printers because of OBSCENE ELEMENTS IN HIS PROSE

1° work: Chamber Music (collection of 36 short poems)

Dubliners → collection of short stories all about Dublin and its life. → Appreciated by Pound (American poet) who helped him to print "A Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man" (semi-autobiographical novel)

ZURICH 1915-20 (financial difficulties)

1917 received the first of several anonymous donations which enabled him to continue writing the novel Ulysses.

PARIS 1920-40

1922 publishes "Ulysses" → BOTH PRAISE AND SHARP CRITICISM

Pound: "It was the most important expression which the modern age has found"

→ Daughter's mental illness → sent to a mental hospital + father's death → decade of Joyce's life

ZURICH 1940-41

→ intestinal operation → died and buried in Zurich in 1941

ORDINARY DUBLIN

AT 22 -> VOLUNTARY EXILE -> SET OFF HIS WORKS (+ IN CITY OF DUBLIN) IN IRELAND

AIM: give a realistic portrait of the life of ordinary people doing ordinary things.

The whole of man's mental, emotional and biological reality fused with the culture of modern civilisation.

THE REBELLION AGAINST THE CHURCH -> LINK -> A Modest Proposal (Swift) - BIRTH CONTROL < ENW 1984

revolt of the artist-heretic against the official doctrine

↳ a provincial church which had taken possession of Irish minds.

STYLE

THE ARTIST'S TASK WAS TO RENDER LIFE OBJECTIVELY in order to give back a TRUE IMAGE of IT.

↳ led to the ISOLATION AND DETACHMENT OF THE ARTIST FROM SOCIETY

↳ Joyce used different points of view and narrative techniques APPROPRIATE TO THE CHARACTERS PORTRAYED

-> From Dubliners -> use of free direct speech

↳ interior monologue WITH TWO levels of narration -> To give a realistic framework to the characters' formless thoughts

↳ up to the extreme interior monologue

LANGUAGE: succession of words without punctuation or grammatical connections

↳ Reality = place of psychological projections & cultural knowledge

HIS BLINDNESS was compensated by his sense of EAR and the SOUND OF WORDS was very important to him.

- **A subjective perception of time**

FACTS are explored from different points of view
-> Geographical and sociological details
He analysed the impressions and thoughts that an event had caused in the inner world of the character.
-> Novels open in MEDIA RES with the analysis of a particular moment
TIME WAS SUBJECTIVE -> leading to psychological change
-> description of Dublin -> come from the characters' floating mind.

DUBLINERS

STRUCTURE AND SETTING
15 short stories -> lack obvious actions
↳ disclose human situations and moments of intensity and lead to a moral, social or spiritual revelation.
The stories are arranged in 4 groups:
- childhood -> youth in Dublin
- adolescence
- maturity
- public life

} middle years of characters and their social, political and religious affairs
→ the last one "The Dead" -> summarises themes and motifs of the other 14 stories

Dublin: he chose it for the scene because that city seemed to me the centre of paralysis.
↳ Joyce was hostile to city life -> his Dublin is a place where true feeling and compassion for others do not exist

CHARACTERS:
Dubliners as afflicted people -> oppressive effect of RELIGIOUS, POLITICAL, CULTURAL and ECONOMIC forces
↳ on lower-middle-class.

-> CAUGHT UP IN AN ENDLESS WEB OF DISPAIR
↳ unable to escape -> spiritually weak (young woman in Eveline)

REALISM AND SYMBOLISM
-> Realistic description and extremely concise (more external details)
Use of Realism mixed with symbolism (external details have a deeper meaning)
↳ The name of some objects stands out from the naturalistic context ("street organ" -> "harmonium" in Eveline)
Religious symbolism -> destiny of Eveline = her mother
Colour symbolism -> brown, grey & yellow -> atmosphere of despair and paralysis.

THE USE OF EPIPHANY
use of symbolism to take the reader beyond the usual aspects of life through the analysis of the particular
-> EPIPHANY: "THE SUDDEN SPIRITUAL MANIFESTATION" caused by a trivial gesture, external object or a banal situation (A TRIGGER (WITH 5 SENSES)), which reveals the character's inner truths.
↳ REVELATORY MOMENTS -> reader focused on real meaning of narration

STYLE
- Interior monologue
- Chiasmus (patterned repetition of images) -> can create melodic effect
-> In the first three stories (childhood) -> first-person narrator (nameless/unidentified)
-> the other 12 stories -> 3rd person narrator
↳ point of view of a young boy to understand him better

reflects language and sensivity of who was described

shares a particular character's perspective

(free direct speech)

-> Narrator tends to disappear in the interior monologue
↳ Protagonist's pure thoughts are introduced without any reporting verbs -> DIRECT knowledge of the character's mind

Language of Dubliners -> adapted to the class, age and role of character -> SIMPLE, OBJECTIVE and NEUTRAL

- **Paralysis** < physical (from external forces) / moral (religion, politics & culture)

Joyce's Dubliners accepted their conditions
↳ They lack the courage to break the chains that bind them
-> AWARENESS OF SELF-REALISATION -> knowing oneself is basis of morality

OPPOSITE of "PARALYSIS" is "ESCAPE" -> none succeeds in freeing themselves
↳ originated from an impulse caused by a sense of enclosure

- **Stream of consciousness**

a literary technique which consists in reproducing the free flow of thoughts, feelings & sensations of the characters without comment by the author. representation is chaotic and fragmented
↳ Technique similar to that of the interior monologue, but here the structure is more clear and coherent.

(A) PORTRAIT OF THE ARTIST AS A YOUNG MAN (80% Joyce's autobiography)

TITLE
-> one of the possible interpretation of the artist as a figure
-> SUBJECT: mind of the protagonist and the development of his personality.

MAZE -> different choices
↳ LIFE -> create a way to live
↳ in another reality -> different school for example
-> if you lived in a different environment you would be a different person

PASSAGGI FONDAMENTALI DELLA SUA VITA! + EPIFANIE!

PLOT AND SETTING

Novel of EDUCATION -> 5 chapters

Stephen Dedalus -> young Irish writer in search of experience and success.

Set in Dublin -> follows Stephen's life from childhood through adolescence until the age of 20

-> son of poor father & very devout Catholic mother (like Joyce) + attends Jesuit school -> extremist religious
-> Torquemada (Spanish inquisitor)

-> he begins to rebel against his family, religion and nation.
-> HE SEEKS VOLUNTARY EXILE IN PARIS to find his identity

THE HERO: STEPHEN DEDALUS

first christian martyr (martyr to art) -> killed himself for religion

-> mythical dimension
-> Dedalus built the Maze's Minotaur under Minos
-> like him Stephen must escape from the social, political labyrinth of Dublin's life

Stephen's Transformations:
- first is from a shy little boy to a bright student who understands social interactions.
- Second -> when he sleeps with a Dublin prostitute -> from innocence to corruption
- Third -> from unrepentant sinner to a devout Catholic
- Fourth -> from fanatical religiousness to a new devotion to art and beauty } he refused a place in Jesuit order

previously contradicted

Stephen refuse + epiphany on the beach
-> mark his transition from belief in God to belief in aesthetic beauty

PERPETUAL CHANGES UNTILL THE END -> when he becomes a FULLY FORMED ARTIST.

STYLE

↳ BEGINNING : third-person narrator

END : first-person narrator

MOST of characters and events are based on real characters and events BUT FILTERED THROUGH THE consciousness of a fictional character (Stephen)

JOYCE REPRESENTS THE COMPLEX INNER LIVES OF HIS CHARACTERS BY EXPERIMENTING WITH POINTS OF VIEW

↳ Stephen = UNIFYING CONSCIOUSNESS

↳ when he started to narrate (with free direct speech) his own experience & thought

the third-narrator disappears

ex. Stephen's revelation about his future as an artist = "Stephen thought"

↳ passage from a moment of external description and action into Stephen's thoughts

LANGUAGE < Beginning : simple (child)
End : articulate (student) altered

INTERNATIONAL WOMEN'S DAY

→ In Germany women asic for equal rights

↳ preceded the general meeting of the socialist second International

At the International